

Cover Letter

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Hiring Manager

Vesta

Platform Engineering Lead Position

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Platform Engineering Lead position at Vesta. As someone who has spent over two decades architecting and scaling distributed systems for financial services, I am deeply excited about your mission to modernize the mortgage industry's core infrastructure. Your vision of replacing antiquated processes with a modern, open, and automated platform resonates strongly with my experience transforming legacy financial systems into cloud-native architectures.

Why I'm Excited About Vesta

Having worked extensively in fintech at Barclays, where I led the cloud adoption journey and transformed monolithic systems into event-driven microservices, I understand firsthand the challenges of modernizing financial infrastructure while maintaining the reliability and security that regulated environments demand. Your approach to building a next-generation system of record aligns perfectly with the architectural principles I've championed throughout my career.

Relevant Technical Leadership Experience

In my current role as Director of Cloud Architecture at Biophy, I've been hands-on in designing and implementing comprehensive infrastructure as code, following AWS best practices while maintaining about 40% of my time coding. My recent work includes:

- **Distributed Systems Architecture:** Led the migration of complex event-driven mainframe systems to AWS serverless architecture using EventBridge, Lambda, and Step Functions at McKinsey, directly applicable to building Vesta's scalable platform
- **Platform Engineering Excellence:** At Yotascale, I architected a multi-cloud cost analytics platform supporting AWS, Azure, and GCP, designing scalable data pipelines and microservices

with PostgreSQL and Kubernetes

- **High-Performance Systems:** Implemented event streaming with Kafka, distributed caching, and optimized database performance for systems handling millions of transactions daily

Technical Alignment and Growth Mindset

While my primary expertise lies in Java, Python, and Node.js ecosystems, I have extensive experience with the architectural patterns and distributed systems principles that transcend language boundaries. My work with:

- **Kubernetes/EKS:** Deployed and managed production workloads across multiple organizations
- **PostgreSQL:** Designed and optimized schemas for high-throughput financial systems
- **Kafka:** Built event-driven architectures for real-time data processing
- **AWS:** Deep expertise across the entire AWS ecosystem
- **Redis/Caching:** Implemented distributed caching solutions for performance optimization

demonstrates the technical foundation that would allow me to quickly adapt to your C#/.NET stack while bringing valuable cross-platform insights.

Leadership and Team Building

At Barclays, I directed the distributed systems technology strategy for the organization, leading a 30-member working group and establishing architectural standards that transformed how teams approached cloud adoption. I'm passionate about:

- Building and mentoring high-performing engineering teams
- Establishing engineering best practices that scale across organizations
- Balancing technical excellence with pragmatic business delivery
- Creating cultures of innovation while maintaining reliability

Security and Compliance Expertise

Having worked in highly regulated environments at Barclays and managed SOC 2 compliance requirements in previous roles, I understand the importance of maintaining robust security postures while enabling rapid innovation. I've implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting systems that ensure both compliance and operational excellence.

Why I'm the Right Fit

What excites me most about this opportunity is the chance to help build the foundational infrastructure that will transform an entire industry. My experience spans the technical depth needed for hands-on

platform development and the leadership breadth required to build and scale engineering organizations. I thrive in environments where technical excellence meets real-world impact, and Vesta's mission to democratize homeownership through better technology is exactly the kind of challenge that motivates me.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building scalable, reliable platforms for financial services can contribute to Vesta's success. I'm particularly interested in learning more about your technical roadmap and how you envision scaling the platform to meet the demands of the multi-trillion dollar mortgage market.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of joining your exceptional team and helping build the future of financial infrastructure.

Sincerely,

Yongjun Rong